TRIO

STUDENT SUPPORT SERVICES

Where Success Begins

Promoting Social Justice and Equity

QUALITATIVE & QUANTITATIVE

2020-2021

Your Graduation is Our Goal



Quantitative and Qualitative Evaluation Report 2020-2021

TRIO Student Support Services

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Project Director

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Database Intern

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Where Success Begins

Wichita State University
August 2020

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LETTER FROM TRIO STUDENT SUPPORT SERVICES PROJECT DIRECTOR

Yes, we made it through (2020-2021)! We are grateful to have made it through what was an extremely tough year due to Covid 19. The campus completely closed at one point and at another point the campus was hybrid. Students were given the chance to attend classes in-person or take them online. Whatever the choice, it became clear that even more important than academics was the need to support students both mentally and emotionally.

We used our centralized website to keep participants abreast of news from the Center for Disease Control (CDC) regarding Covid 19 as well as things they should considering doing on a day-to-day basis to stay mentally and physically healthy.

The 2020-2021 academic year is the first of a five-year grant cycle. The United States Department of Education awarded $2,474,645.00 to Wichita State University TRIO Student Support Services for 2020-2025.

U.S. Department of Education

2020-2025 (five-year cycle)

$2,474,645.00

Endowed Scholarships Awarded

2020-2021

$7,740.00

Educational Opportunity Fund

$4,500.00

Total Federal Assistance

$3,777,706

The Competitive Preference Priorities as named by the United States Department of Education are as follows:

Fostering Flexible and Affordable Paths to Obtaining Knowledge and Skills

- TRIO Student Support Services purchased 150 seats in VirtualJobShadow.com for our students to explore the limitless career exploration options and professional skills needed in the workforce today. Our students can use this website to explore a plethora of careers and professionals who operate in many occupations.

- As many employers were working remotely and/or not allowing visitors to their offices, our students needed another option to obtain the knowledge and skills needed for job-readiness.
- We had a free workshop presented to our students by the Career Development Center who gave them options for not only finding virtual jobs and internships, but other opportunities to help prepare for their new jobs. The presenter gave valuable information and resources on obtaining proper work attire at little to no cost, how to schedule a mock interview, and more.

Fostering Knowledge and Promoting the Development of Skills That Prepare Students To Be Informed, Thoughtful, and Productive Individuals and Citizens

- TRIO Student Support Services offered a series of workshops designed to develop informed, thoughtful, and productive participants/citizens. One main path by which students were encouraged to think critically was to go to the SSS central website and identify a posted article or video (student decides) and use the posted rubric to provide an analysis of an article or video. The articles and videos are current and regarding issues in higher education around the United States. he material. For example, issues as the pertain to SSS programs, SSS funding, and social justice and equity.
- The articles are on issues pertaining to higher education and connected to SSS programs and funding, social justice, and equity around the United States.



The SSS program goals are to increase retention, and graduation rates of its 250 participants from one academic year to the other (fall to fall), aid students in staying in good academic standing, and nurture an environment of support and equity. This report features the students served and the professional staff who serve them.

I have been a social justice curriculum specialist for more than thirty years. I believe the TRIO Student Support Service Project s allows me to do my best Social Justice and Equity work.

Dr. Linda F. Rhone, SSS Director
Wichita State University
Social Justice & Equity Curriculum Specialist

Summary of Grant Objectives and Outcomes

Goal: The extent to which project participants persisted toward completion of academic programs in which they were enrolled.

Objective 1: **74%** of all participants served by the SSS Project will persist from one academic year to the beginning of the next academic year or will have earned a bachelor's degree at the grantee institution during the academic year.

Outcome: **72%**

Goal: The extent to which project participants met academic performance levels required to stay in good academic standing at the grantee institution.

Objective 2: **86%** of all enrolled SSS participants being served will meet the performance level required to stay in good academic standing (GPA 2.0 & above) at the grantee institution.

Outcome: **88%**

Goal: The extent to which project participants graduated.

Objective 3: **36%** of new participants served each year will graduate from the guarantee institution with a bachelor's degree or equivalent within six (6) years.

Outcome: **34%**

CHANGE AGENTS





MISSION

To provide academic support services that help first-generation and limited-income students, and students with disabilities to successfully persist and graduate from Wichita State University.

VISION

To become a model of excellence in assisting first-generation and limited-income students, and students with disabilities to successfully persist and graduate from college

CORE VALUES

Committed to providing efficient, effective, and excellent service to students.

ACHIEVEMENTS

2020-In March of 2020, Wichita State University abruptly changed to a virtual campus due to a world pandemic (Covid-19). TRIO SSS-staff worked remotely (via Zoom) with SSS participants for academic advising and wellness checks. SSS tutors offered tutoring (via Zoom) to SSS tutees.

2021-On Friday, May 14th, 2021, from 11:00 am until 12:30 pm, TRIO Student Support Services (SSS) hosted the 42nd Annual Student Recognition & Awards Ceremony – aka the second "SSS Virtual Celebration of Graduation." The celebration took place via the online platform Zoom. During the event, SSS students were given the platform to share their perspectives, thoughts, and accomplishments of the 2020-2021 school year. Among the presenters were: Ms. Bridget Kennedy, Mr. Billy Wilson, and SSS Tutor, Ms. Nicole Blomquist. All graduates were also encouraged to wear their regalia to the ceremony.

SERVICES PROVIDED FOR SSS-PARTICIPANTS

SSS program offers its participants a variety of free services to help support their academic success. Each participant is assigned an academic advisor and offered personalized services to meet individual academic needs. Services offered to program participants include:

- Academic Advice & Assistance
- Academic & Life Smart Skill Development
- Textbook Library
- FAFSA Application
- Financial & Economic Literacy
- Graduate School Enrollment Advice
- Individualized Tutoring
- Scholarships Exclusively for SSS students
- SSS Technology Learning Lab

Required Services

WSU-SSSP offers all participants accepted into the project the following required services and activities:

- Academic tutoring
- Advice and assistance in course selection
- Information on Federal financial aid programs and benefits
- Assistance in completing the FAFSA
- Education or counseling services designed to improve financial and economic literacy
- Assistance to apply and obtain financial assistance for graduate and professional programs
- Activities to assist participants in the project with admission to and enrollment in graduate and professional programs.

Permissible Services

WSU-SSSP offers all participants accepted into the project the following permissible services and activities:

- Individualized counseling for personal, career and academic matters
- Information, activities and instruction on the range of career options available
- Exposure to cultural events and programs
- Mentoring programs
- Grant Aid to eligible student

Student Support Services Team

Tracking And Evaluation Component



The Tracking and Evaluation Component (TEC) focuses on accurate and continuous tracking of students' academic progress. The TEC coordinator maintains project database files that are used to generate program activity reports. Specifically, TEC's main function is to collect, record, and evaluate data gathered from services provided to students. Additionally, the TEC is charged with assessing areas that need improvement and generating periodic reports to show the project's progress toward achieving grant funded objectives. The TEC is coordinated by our Database Specialist and Academic Advisor, Ms. Kamika Thomas-Hicks.

Specifically, Ms. Thomas-Hicks tracks and monitors data for accuracy and relevance to project objectives. As the coordinator, Ms. Thomas-Hicks reviews project-developed assessment tools to ensure that they are designed to effectively capture relevant data. She gathers, reviews, and compiles reports each semester from campus departments including the registrar's office and office of financial aid. The data is evaluated and used to track students' academic performance and identify areas that need improvement. She ensures that data is appropriately filed and securely stored in a database. Ms. Thomas-Hicks is also responsible for providing data access to staff members. She prepares and facilitates monthly, annual, and special reports including an SSS Annual Performance Report (APR) to the U.S. Department of Education.

In addition, the TEC coordinator is charged with preparing an annual Quantitative and Qualitative (Q&Q) report that is distributed to stakeholders. The report summarizes the program's activities and performance. Importantly, the Q&Q report allows the program to share its service outcomes with all stakeholders including WSU President, vice presidents, scholarship donors, and the Wichita community.

In sum, the TEC is critical to ensure the program services and improvement efforts remain committed to the core values of providing efficient, effective, and excellent services to participants. Data is reviewed and evaluated regularly to monitor areas that need improvement and shared with relevant components. For instance, data that is compiled and evaluated from tutor surveys is shared with the TTC coordinator to make tutoring improvement. Similarly, information that is gathered from reports about students' academic performance is used by advisors to plan effective interventions with at-risk students. The TEC helps track and evaluate

the program's success in providing efficient, effective, and excellent services to program participants.

Kamika Thomas-Hicks joined the project as SSS Database Specialist in Spring 2020. She holds a Bachelors' degree in Mathematics. She has grown up in TRIO from middle school to high school. She brought a wealth of experience acquired over many years of working with disadvantaged population in the Wichita area. In the summer of 2021, Ms. Thomas-Hicks resigned from her position after realizing her desire to pursue entrepreneurship.

Database Intern



Hemil Mehul Shah is an International Student from India. Hemil completed his High School Diploma from Dar es Salaam, Tanzania which gave him exposure to working with people of limited-income and disability status. He is currently a Junior pursuing his degree in Computer Science at Wichita State University.

He joined the Student Support Services staff family in Fall 2020 as a student assistant. Hemil started his role as a Database Specialist Intern in Summer 2021. He works on multiple projects which include but are not limited to updating and maintaining the database, preparing reports for assessments and other office tasks such as looking after the front desk and assisting other staff members.

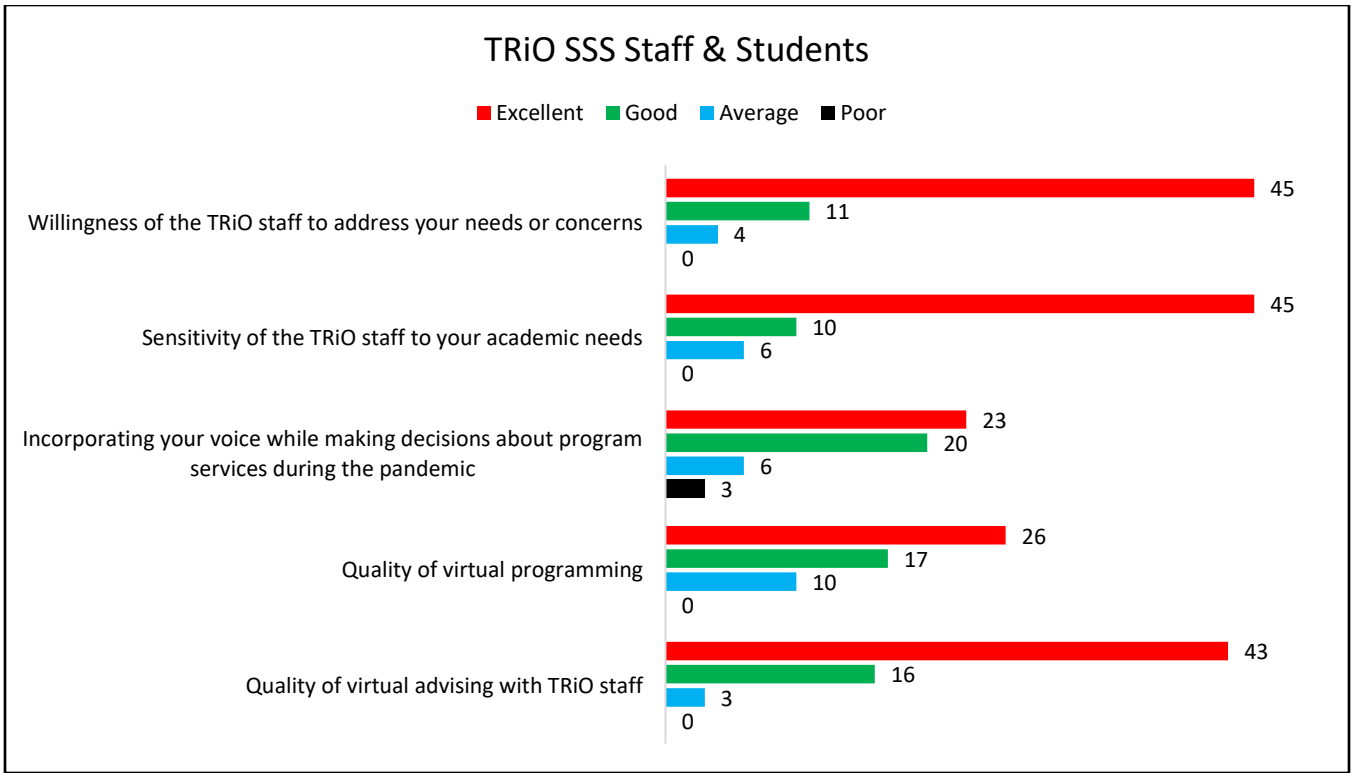


Figure 1: *Source: TRiO Qualtrics Survey 2020-2021*

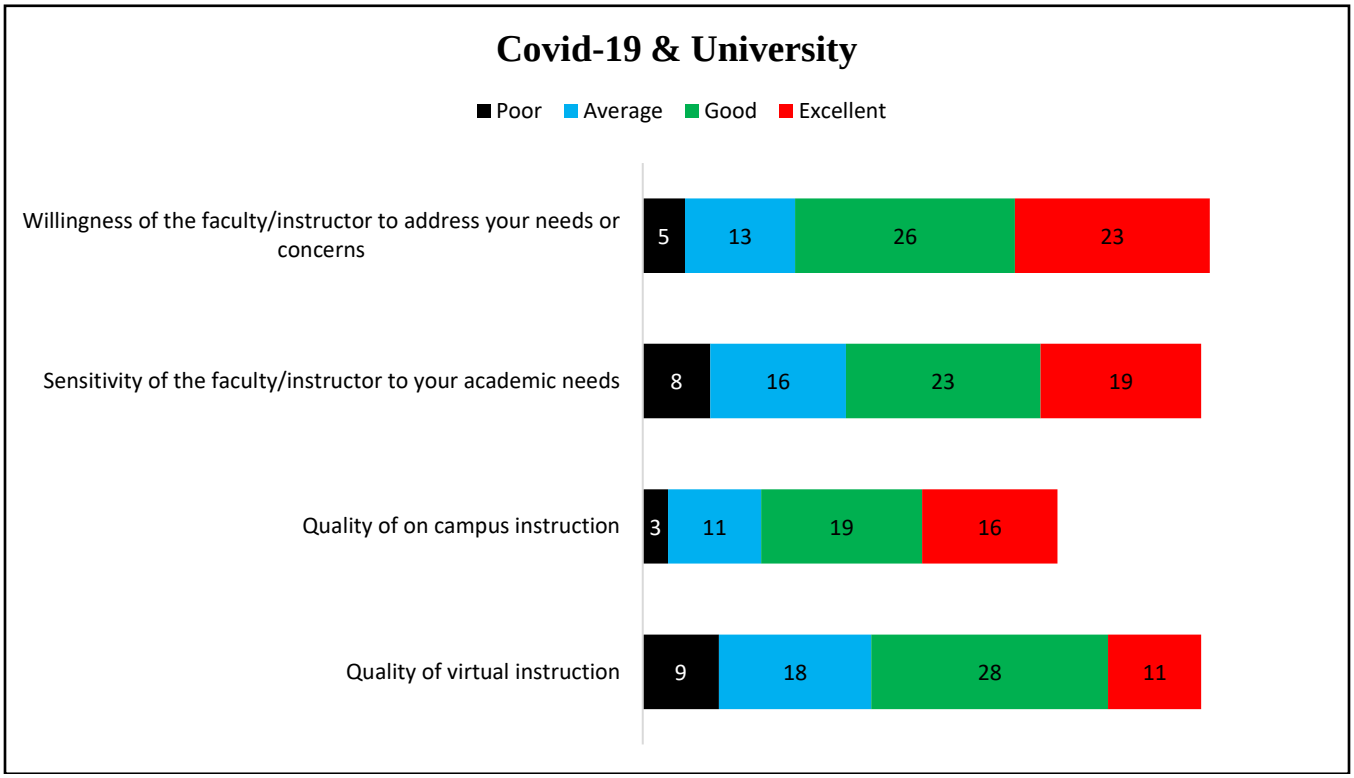


Figure 2: *Source: TRiO Qualtrics Survey 2020-2021*

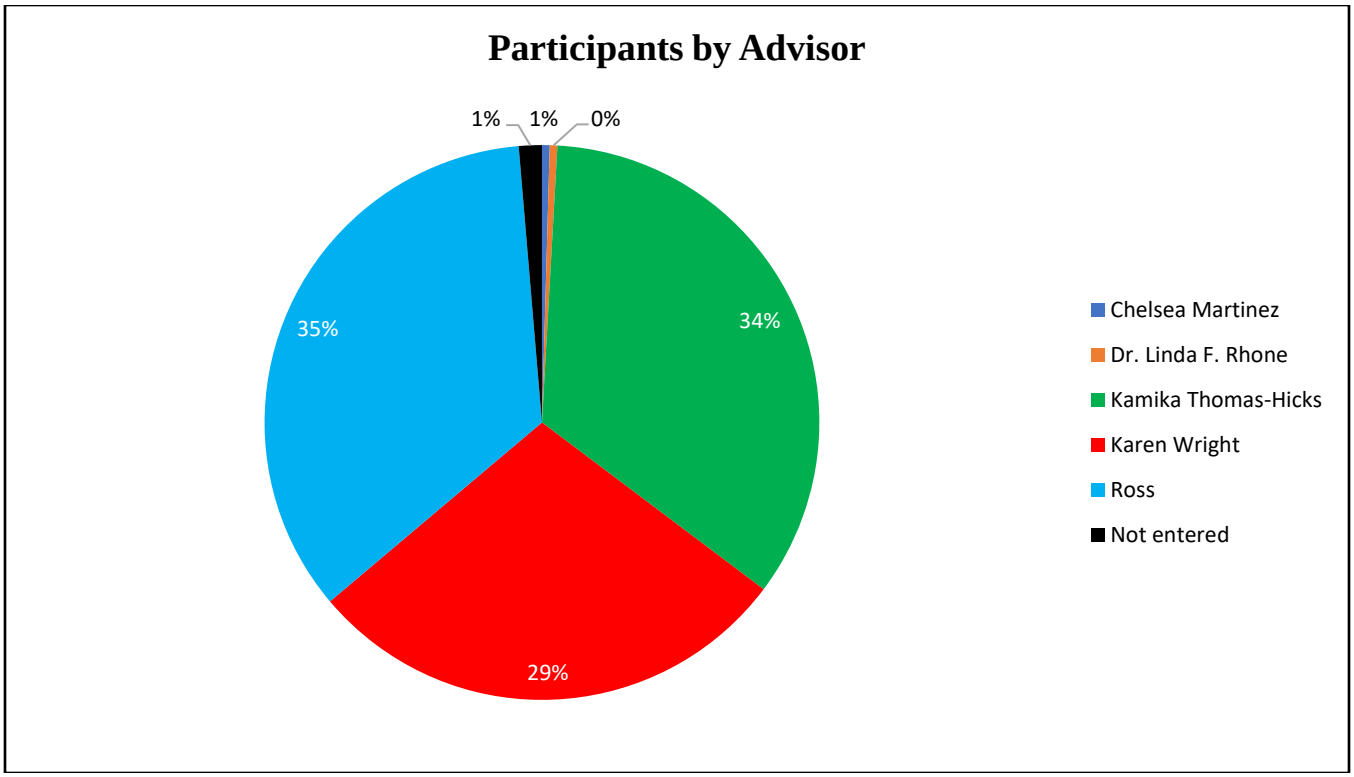
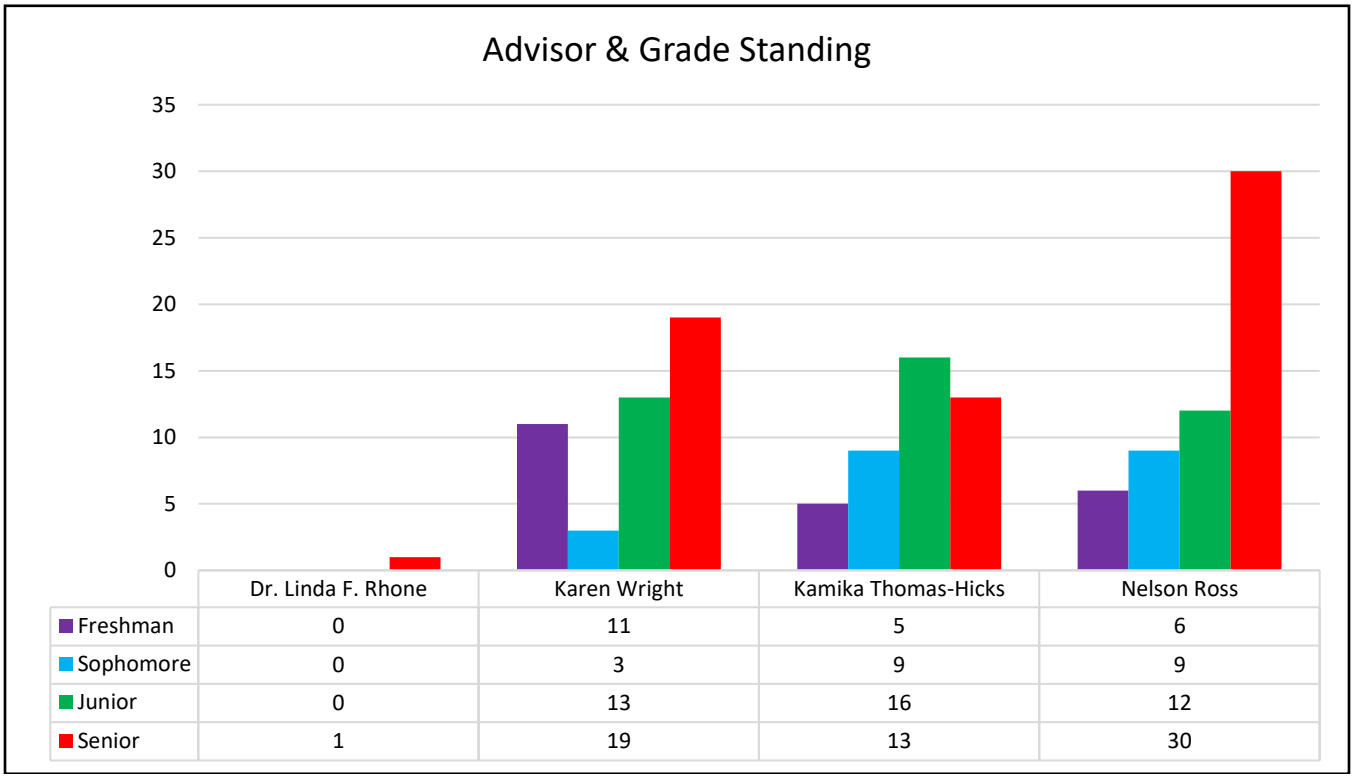


Figure 3: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*



	Dr. Linda F. Rhone	Karen Wright	Kamika Thomas-Hicks	Nelson Ross
Freshman	0	11	5	6
Sophomore	0	3	9	9
Junior	0	13	16	12
Senior	1	19	13	30

Figure 4: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

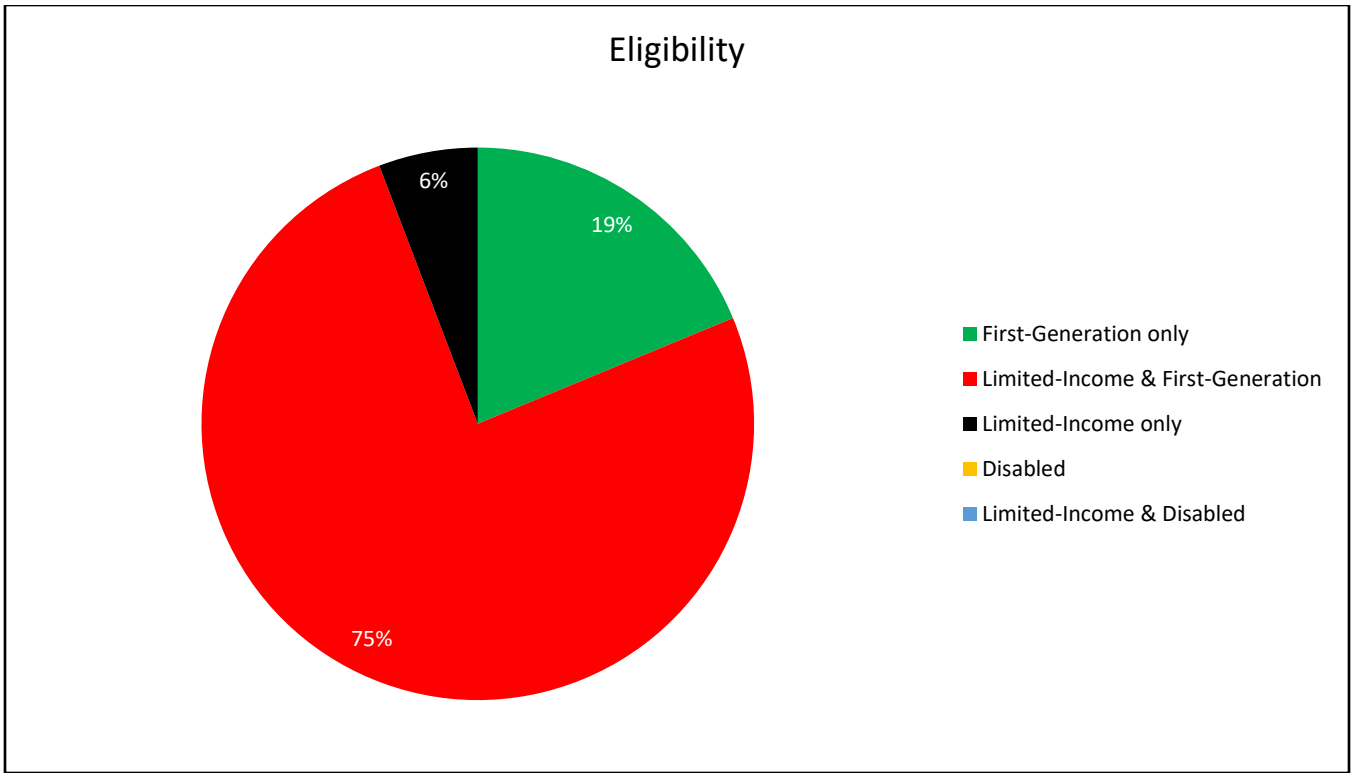


Figure 5: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

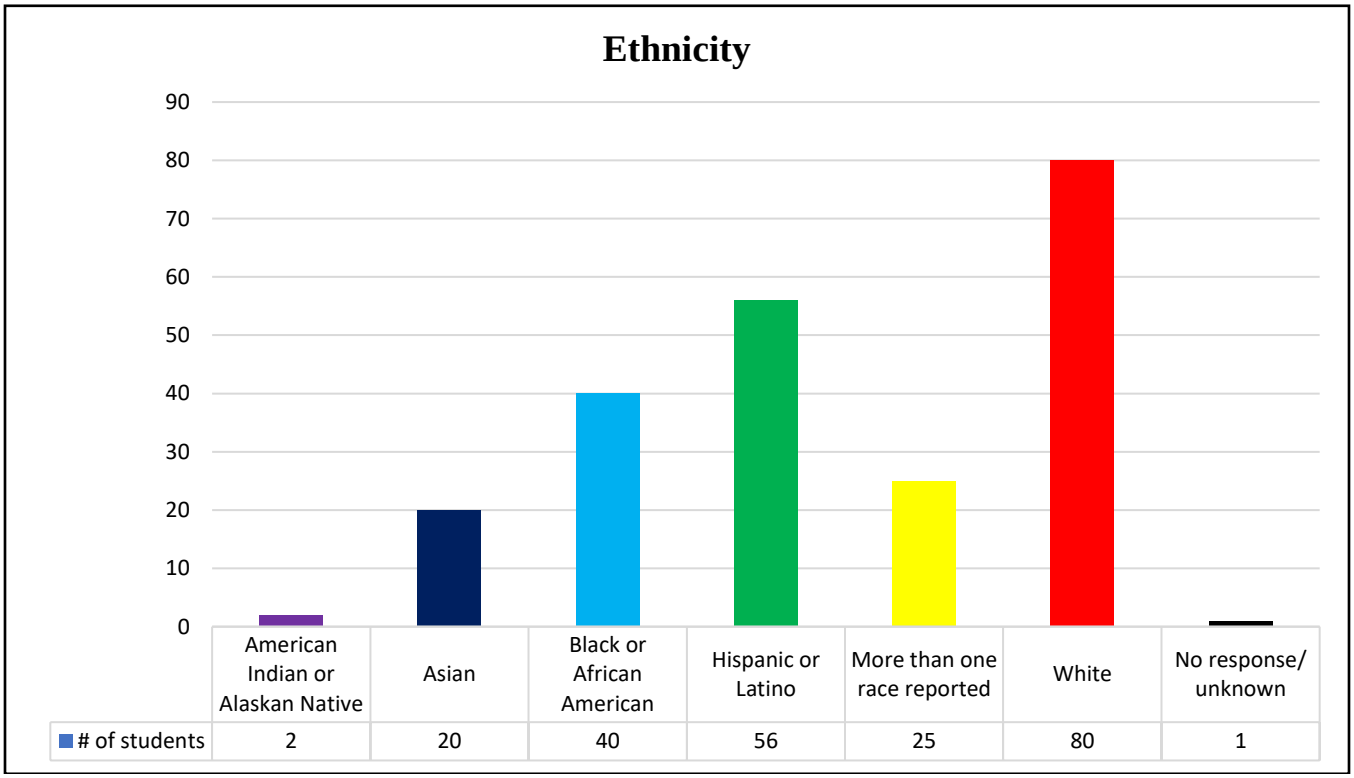


Figure 6: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

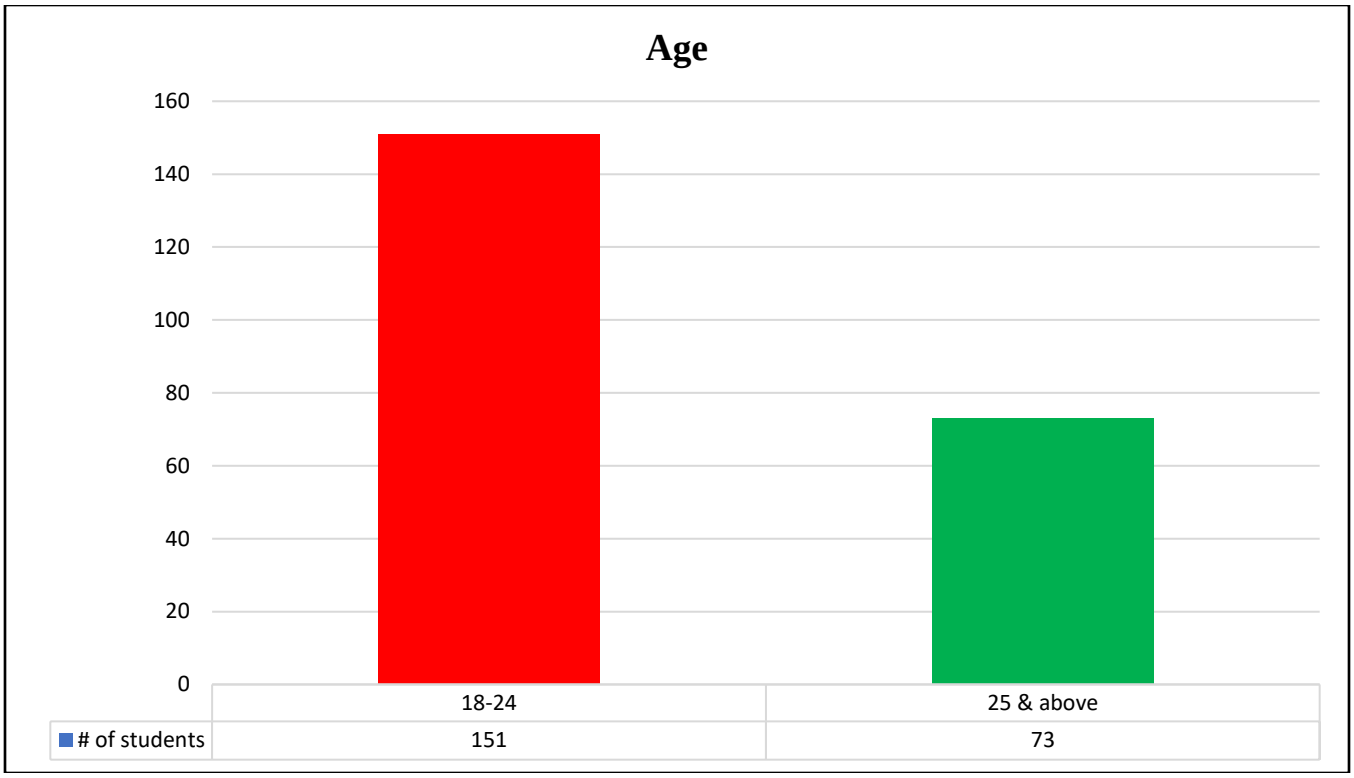


Figure 7: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

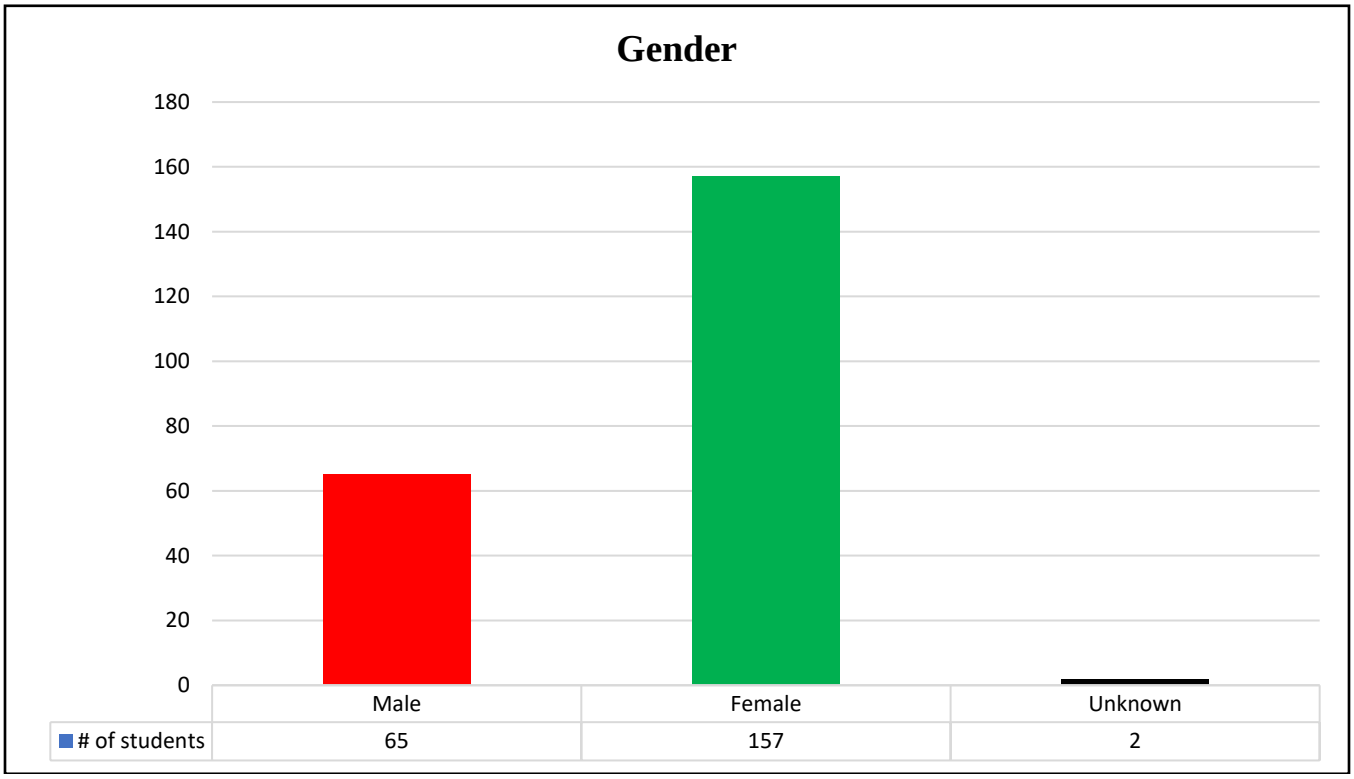


Figure 8: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

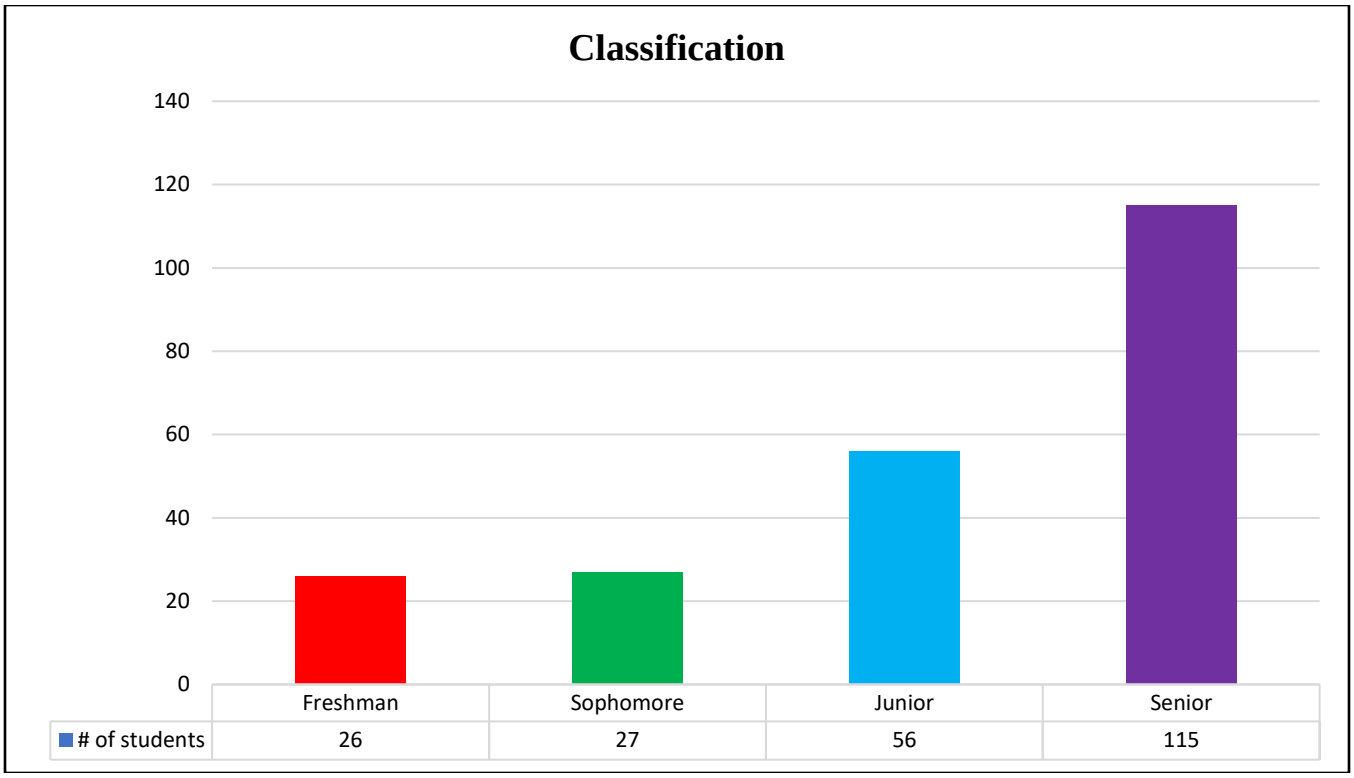


Figure 9: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

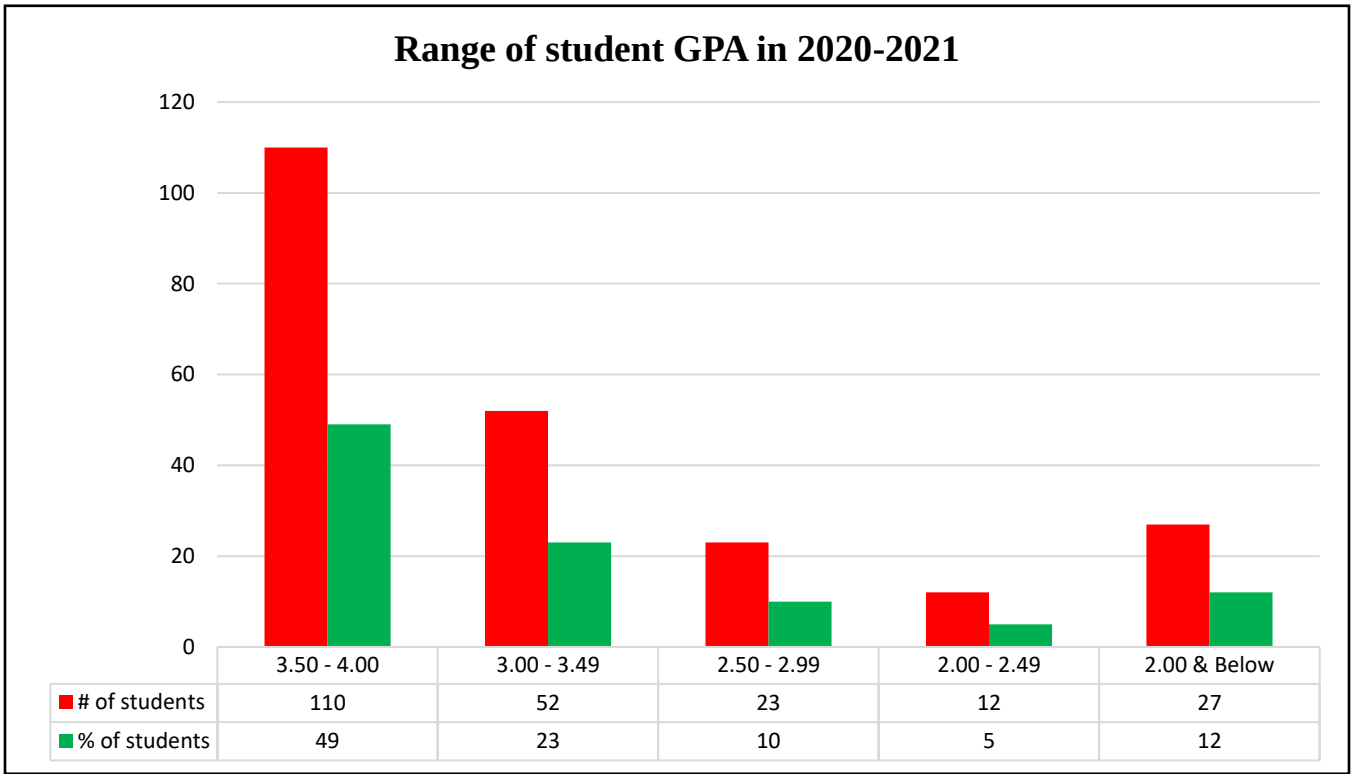


Figure 10: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

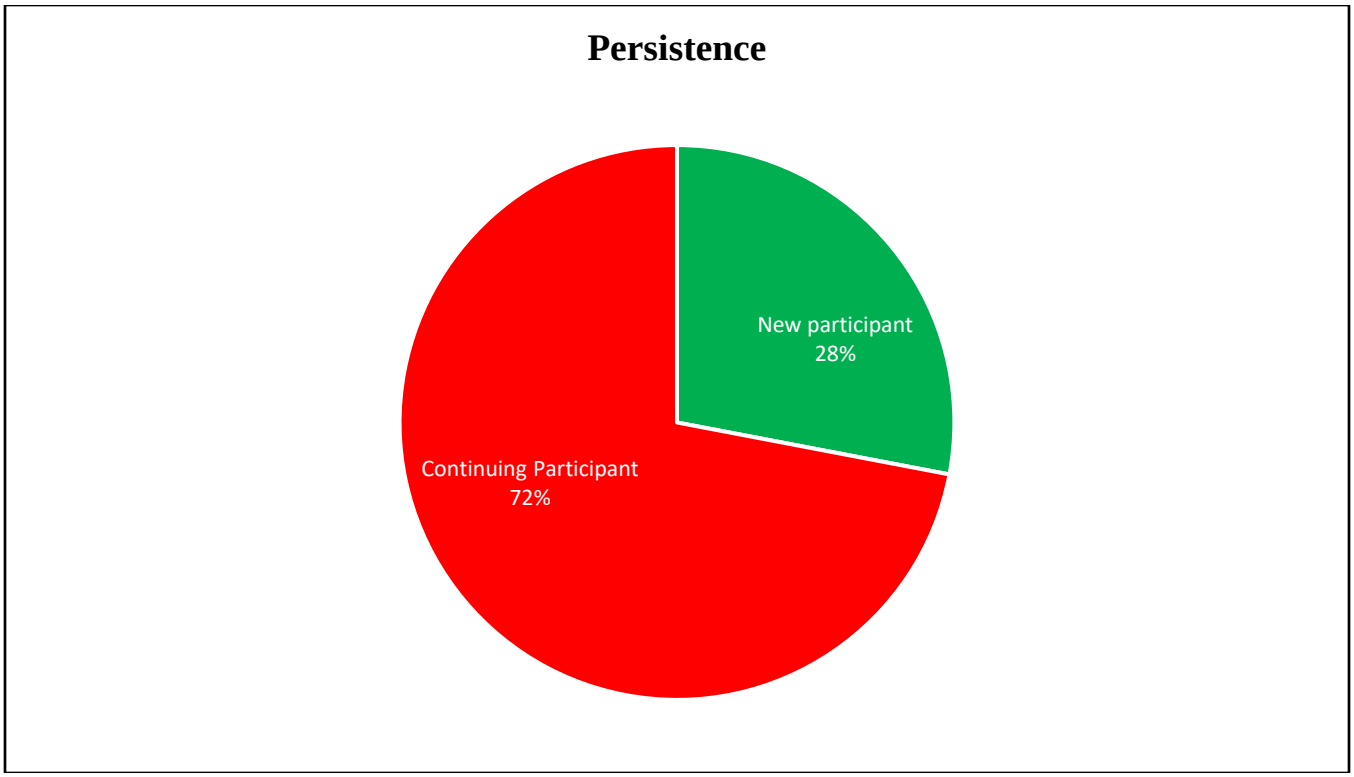


Figure 11: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

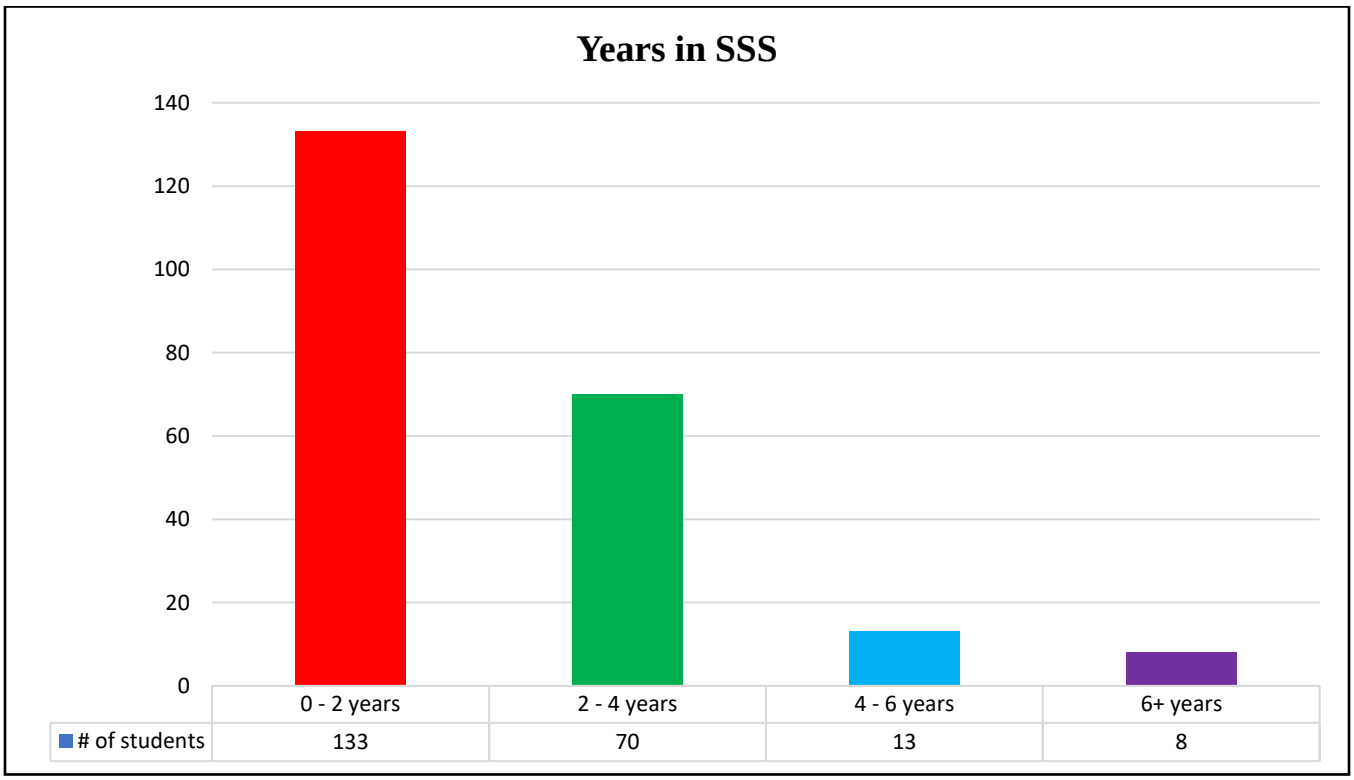


Figure 12: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

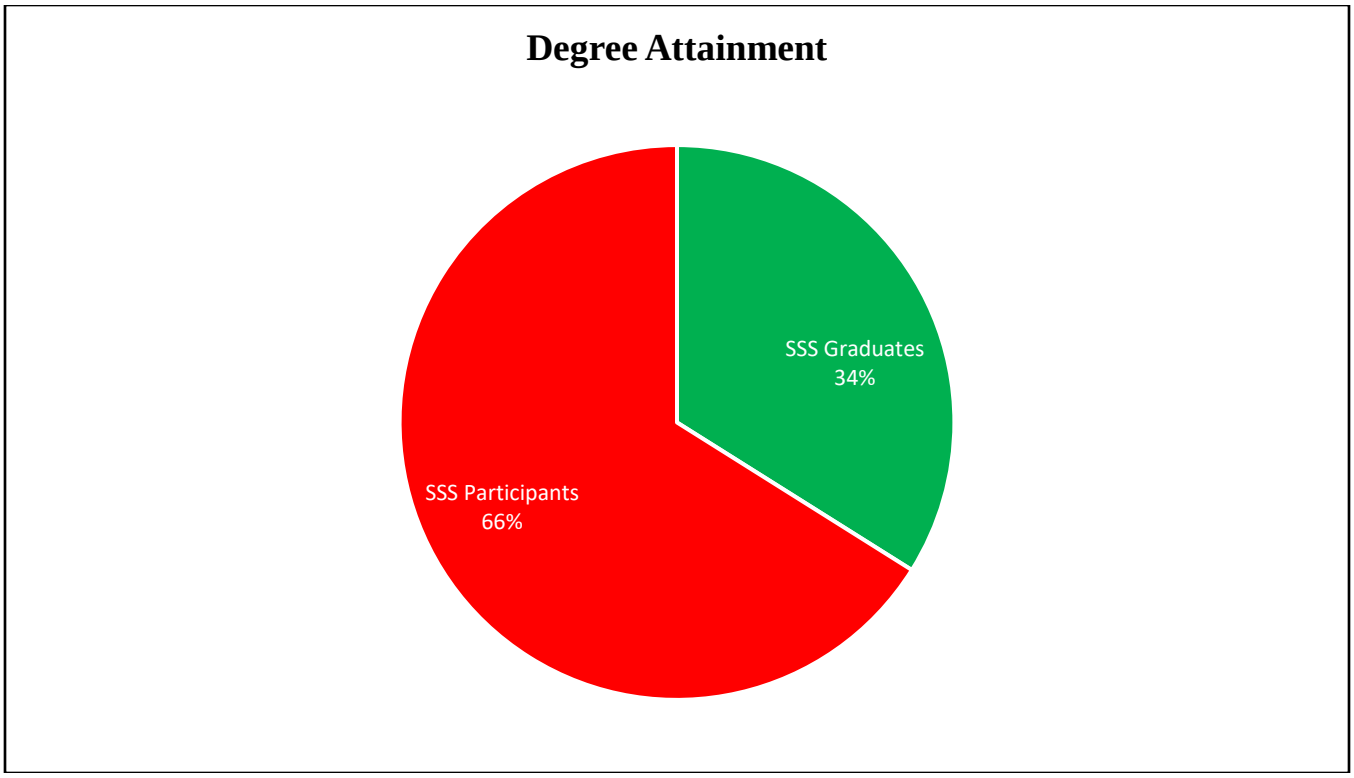


Figure 13: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

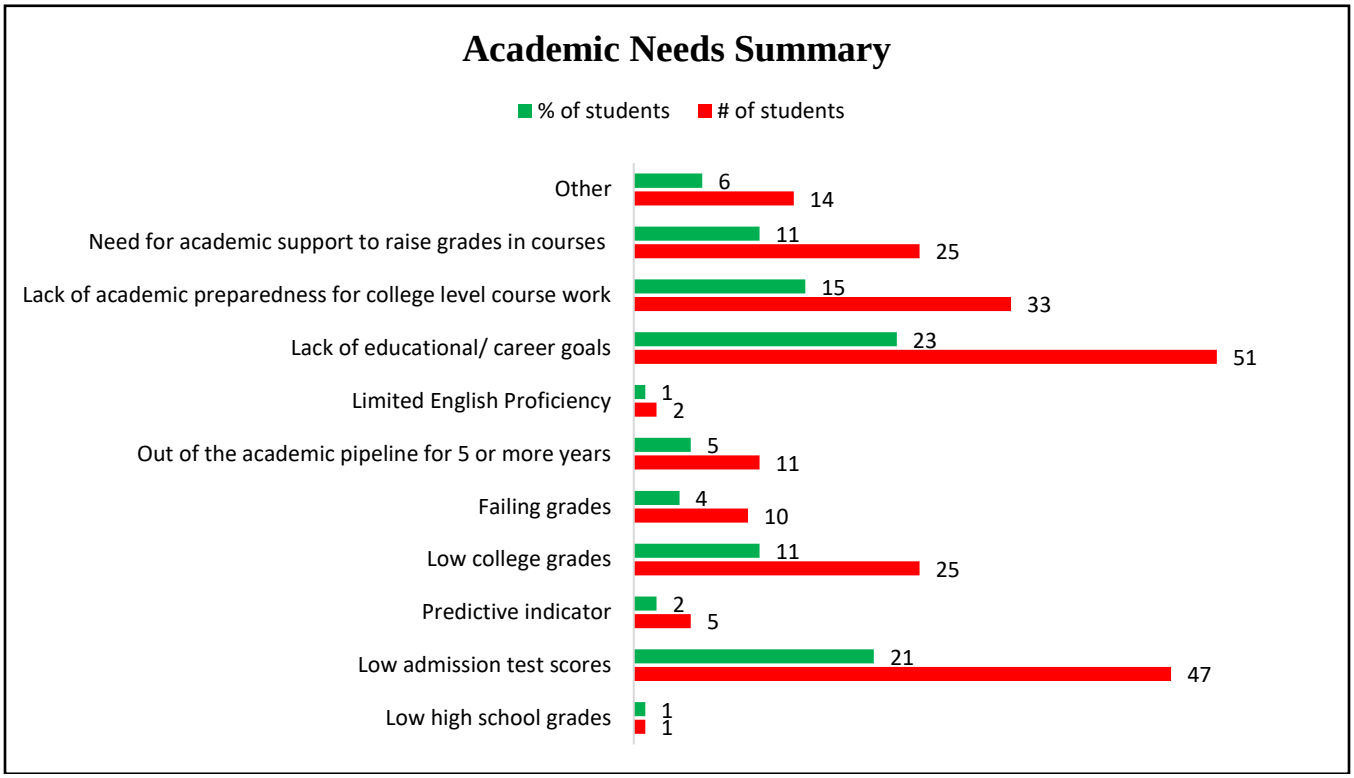


Figure 14: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

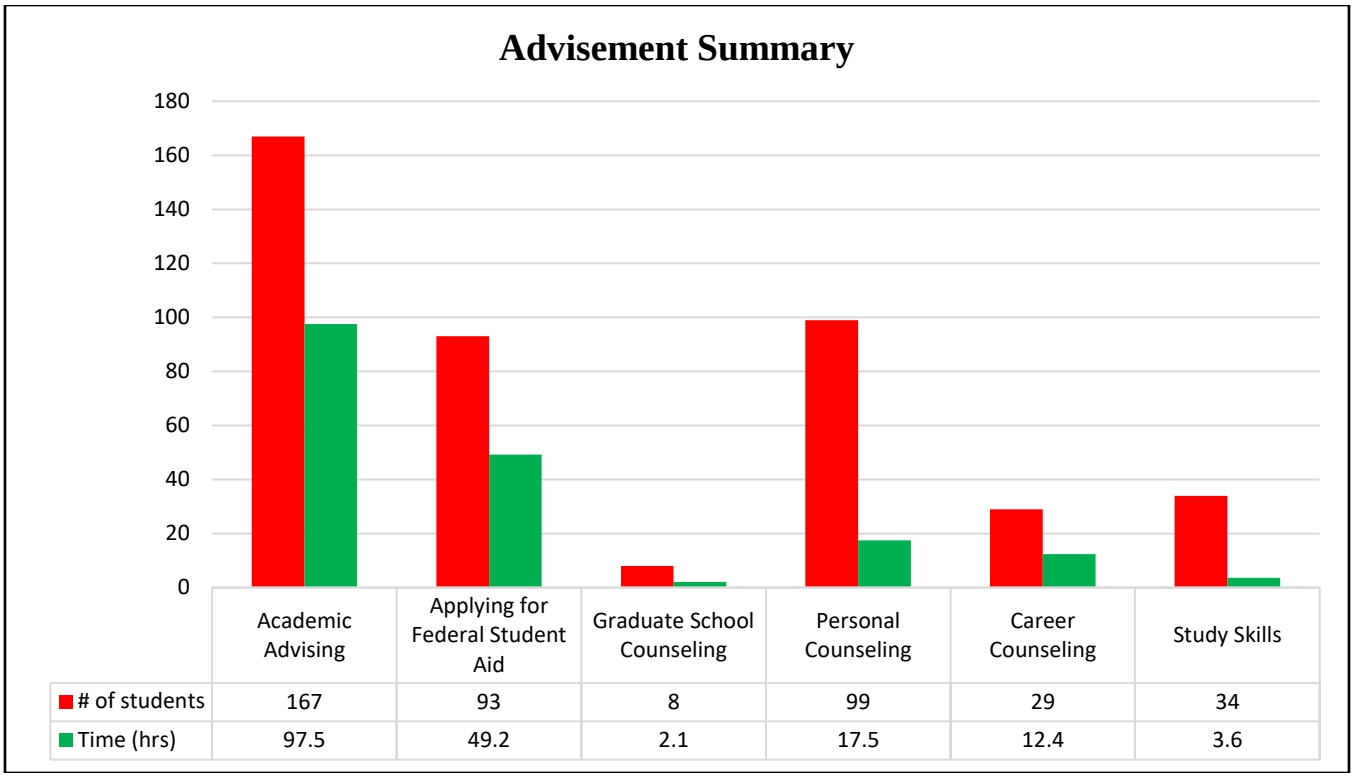


Figure 15: *Source: Blumen Database 2020-2021*

Tutorial And Training Component



The Tutorial and Training Component (TTC) is critical in enhancing student learning and improving the academic success of SSS students at Wichita State University (WSU).

The component is designed to directly impact students' overall academic performance and course completion. Importantly, it helps students develop critical thinking skills and effective problem-solving strategies that are essential for academic success. The TTC is coordinated by the Assistant Director/Academic Advisor, Mrs. Karen Wright. It is generally staffed with over fifteen peer-tutors, and a lead tutor.

Peer tutors are critical in enhancing student learning and improving student academic success. Tutors are recruited and selected based on their academic achievements, class standing, and communication skills. They are recruited from a diverse pool of students across multiple disciplines at WSU. Importantly, prospective tutors are required to have a 3.0 GPA or better in the courses they plan to tutor program participants. The ability to recruit outstanding peer tutors from multiple disciplines across campus, gives TTC the capacity to offer tutoring in multiple courses including biology, chemistry, English, geology, history, mathematics, management, philosophy, physics, Spanish, and statistics. Also, SSS tutors receive extensive training in tutoring best practices. New tutors complete a Level I course that is designed to help them acquire and develop the necessary skills to effectively assist program participants.

The TTC is committed to providing efficiency, effectiveness, and excellent service to program participants. The component's commitment to the program's core values is assessed through tutor evaluations completed by program participants. Evaluations provide feedback that is incorporated into tutor training sessions. Training methods are regularly revised to meet the changing needs of program participants. To maintain its high service standards, the TTC offers College Reading and Learning Association's (CRLA) certification to its tutors. CRLA certification is part of the International Tutor Training program which provides guidance on setting standards for improving tutor training skills.

As the TTC coordinator, Mrs. Wright's main responsibilities include supervising and facilitating quality tutoring services. Mrs. Wright has a wide range of experiences to go along with her experience in higher education. She is more than equipped to effectively work with TRIO SSS-participants.

Graduate Assistant



Sam Jeff D'Souza is an International Student studying at Wichita State University. He was awarded his Bachelor's degree in Mechanical Engineering in Dubai, UAE. He is currently pursuing his Master's degree in Industrial Engineering. Sam has been a part of Student Support Services since Spring 2020 as a Math Tutor. After a year and a half of tutoring, Sam is a CRLA Certified Level 2 Advanced Tutor.

Sam currently serves as a Graduate Staff Assistant and Lead tutor for the Student Support Services. He is working on multiple projects which includes interviewing new tutors and assisting in tutor training. Apart from this, Sam is also working on writing a self-help guidebook for students who have difficulty learning Mathematics, and for tutors teaching Mathematics.

Tutoring Services

19 students requested tutoring during the 2020 – 2021 academic year. A total of 14 (74%) students received individualized tutoring services. A total of 79 credit hours were supported through individualized tutoring for the 2020 – 2021 academic year. This number includes individualized tutoring services provided in Fall 2020 and Spring 2021. Specifically in Fall 2020, 7 students requested tutoring services, out of which 7 received individualized tutoring in 10 catalog courses. In Spring 2021, 12 students requested tutoring services, out of which 9 received individualized tutoring in 11 catalog courses.

Learning Skills and Technology Component



The Learning Skills and Technology Component (LSTC) provides students with assistance in academic and life smart skills. Importantly, it facilitates participants access to computer technology and textbooks.

The LSTC is coordinated by an Academic Advisor, Nelson Ross, and staffed with Lab Assistants (LA). As the coordinator, Mr. Ross oversees a Technology

Learning Lab where students get access to computers, printing, and walk in tutoring services. Specifically, Mr. Ross supervises Lab Assistants and is responsible for coordinating skill building programming for students.

In addition, the LSTC coordinator works with the Office for Student Money Management (OSMM) at Wichita State University (WSU) to provide our participants with financial literacy skills. Specifically, the OSMM provides our program participants with access to MyCollegeMoneyPlan.org website.

The website contains ten modules that allows our students to explore and learn about money matters. Topics covered in the modules include FAFSA completion, loan repayment, and credit reports. The modules are convenient and readily accessible to our participants online. Mr. Ross monitors students' online activities including signing up and completion of modules. The money management online activity is designed to meet the U.S. Department of Education requirement to provide program participants with financial literacy skills.

The LTSC coordinator also provides program participants with study skills training through online academic and life smart skill-building modules. Topics covered by these modules include time management, note-taking, how to read textbooks, test-taking strategies, and listening skills. In addition, an Academic Skills Needs Assessment is completed by each participant as part of the SSS program application. More information about individual student needs is gathered during the course of advising meetings. Information gathered by advisors is used to guide programming of the technology lab services.

SSS Technology Learning Lab Assistants are charged with the task of helping students with course assignments. The assistance provided includes helping students with solving math problems, writing assignments, and course syllabus expectations. This component also offers a library service that includes loaning textbooks acquired through donations from campus departments and students at Wichita State, as well as a grant from the Student Government Association.

The Academic Advisor and LSTC coordinator, Nelson Ross, joined the team of SSS professional staff in September 2017 and remained until June 2021 when he resigned to pursue a doctorate at

Georgetown University. Born in California, Mr. Ross has traveled and lived in Kansas, New York, Los Angeles, London, and for a brief period in Paris. He values the challenge of new and enlightening experiences and describes them as the most important elements of life. Mr. Ross holds a bachelor's degree in political science from the University of Kansas and a Masters' degree in public administration from WSU. Mr. Ross has experience teaching disadvantaged students. More about LSTC is shown in the process chart on the next page.

Fall Semester 2020

- Coping with anxiety workshop
- Learning how to learn/take efficient notes workshop
- Resume workshop
- Budgeting workshop

Spring Semester 2021

- Scholarship workshop
- Virtual job shadows & internships workshop
- Nutrition workshop
- Writing an effective reflective essay workshop
- Mental health workshop
- Virtual celebration of graduation ceremony

Summer 2021

- Juneteenth Volunteer Opportunity
- Motivational 8-to-Great Speaker Patty Stuever

Web Manager



Akashnil Ray is an International Student from India. Akashnil completed his High School Diploma from Agartala, India. This provided him with exposure to persons of limited-income and disability status. He is currently a sophomore pursuing his degree in Aerospace Engineering at Wichita State University.

He joined Student Support Services in Fall 2020 as a Web Manager. He works on multiple projects such as maintaining and designing the Website, designing brochures and flyer for the project, and other office tasks.

Communications And Marketing Component



Although Mrs. Chelsea Martinez worked in the role of Senior Administrative Assistant for her first year in SSS (2019- 2020), her skills were immediately recognized in the areas of Communications, Marketing, and Academic Advising. She was promoted during spring 2021 to Communications, Marketing, and Academic Advising Specialist.

Even though eligible participants are the main target of the program's marketing efforts, our publicity efforts are designed to build strong relations with Wichita State faculty, staff, students, and community. The program's marketing message focuses on the free services provided to help students' transition, persist, and graduate successfully from WSU. Marketing and publicity information is disseminated through print and digital media. In addition, program information is presented at campus events and meetings. Social media is used to publicize program services to students and the community.

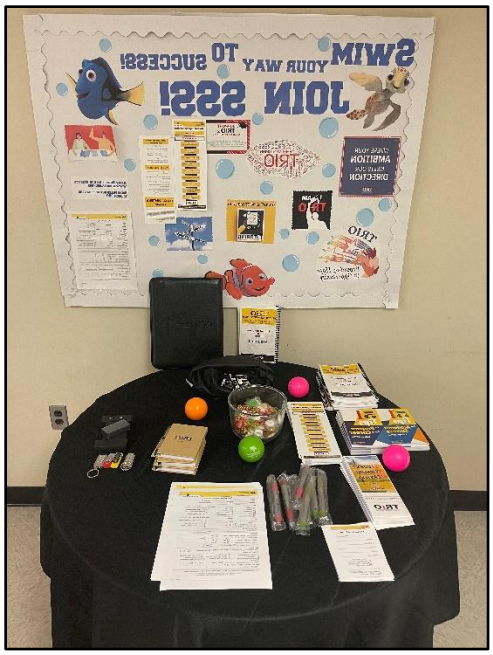
The marketing and publicity of SSS services is a collaborative effort. We work closely with multiple departments on campus to inform the campus community about program services and student eligibility requirements. SSS professional staff share information about services and benefits with faculty, staff, and students at a variety of campus events throughout the year. These events include general faculty and staff meetings, faculty orientation, freshmen orientation, re-entry orientation, student organization meetings, TRIO events, Welcome Fest, group campus visits, and financial aid events. Information is also presented in classroom settings. SSS staff work with faculty to schedule classroom presentations for eligible participants. The partnership and information sharing help publicize services offered by the program to eligible participants and the campus community. Importantly, it helps facilitate student referrals.

The SSS Annual Awards and Recognition Ceremony is the culminating publicity event that helps market the program by showcasing student success. The ceremony is attended by SSS students, tutors, faculty, staff, scholarship donors, community leaders and staff members of the

U.S. Congress and Senators from Kansas. The event's schedule includes student speakers, program alumni, and graduating seniors. At the event, program participants share with faculty, staff, students, and members of the community stories about their challenge, and triumph of their academic journey. More importantly, they provide a testament to the role played by TRIO Student Support Services in their success. The program's strong community relations are celebrated at the event when donors and student recipients of scholarships are recognized.

Social Media Outreach

The Student Support Services website provides a centralized location for students (prospective, current, and alumni) to access online information about program services, activities, and events. Students can access information, complete the program application, update their contact information, request for a tutor, technology, or textbook services. Also, students can access online modules for Financial & Economic Literacy, Academic Success Skill, and Life skill development, and scholarship resources. The SSS website and Facebook page provide students with additional easy and quick access to program activity updates, news and event notifications. The Student Support Services website can be accessed at https://www.wichita.edu/services/student_support/



Pictures of Student Support Services Family 2021 Graduates



From left: *Brittany Matmanivong, Courtney Nunez, Bridget Kenned*



From left: *Maribel Sanchez-Equiha, Layla Rae Berry, Tachina Taylor, Samantha Rowan*

FALL 2020, SPRING 2021 AND SUMMMER 2021 GRADUATES

First Name	Last Name	Major
Abigail	Landrum	Associate in Arts
Aiza	Ortiz	Commun Sciences and Disorders
Alana	Glover	Mechanical Engineering
Allison	Craig	Mathematics 6-12
Amanda	Morgan	Anthropology
Amira	Coleman	Music Performance-Voice
Angela	Portillo	Exercise Science
Anthony	Moran	Graphic Design
Bridget	Kennedy	Genl Studies Criminal Justice
Brielle	Terrell	Sport Management
Brittany	Matmanivong	Nursing
Br'Lia	Jacobs	Social Work & Addiction Cert
Caitlynn	Waller	Elementary Education
Christian	Alvarez	History
Cosima	Le	Commun-Integrated Marketing
Courtney	Nunez	Health Management
Daniel	Gonzales	History and Government 6-12
Danielle	Chapman	General Business
Danniele	Ritter	Social Work
Darrin	McPherson	Industrial Engineering
Deja	Webber	Social Work & Addiction Cert
Eddie	Spurlock	Human Resource Management
Elizabeth	Anderson	Criminal Justice
Elizabeth	De Santiago	Nursing-Accelerated BSN
Emily	Kleiner	Anthropology
Erick	Robles	Electrical Engineering
Evangelina	Esparza	Psychology
Flavio	Perez Castruita	Electrical Engineering
Georgina	LaFoe	Social Work
Goretti	Mendez-Vallejo	Social Work
Gregory	Trechak	Economics
Hoang	Nguyen	Mechanical Engineering
Isabella	Wages	Dental Hygiene
Jameelah	Haley	Intl Studies - Area Studies
James	Ortega	Sport Management
Jamie	Barrett	Elementary Education

Janira	Silva	Forensic Science
Jannet	Balderrama Lopez	Biological Sciences BA
Jordan	Phimmasone	Computer Engineering
Jorghialyn-Thi	Kimble	Health Science
Jose	Canales Breceda	Industrial Engineering
Kaylee	Rasmussen	Art Emphasis
Kieu	Nguyen	Nursing-Accelerated BSN
Lashaya	Lawrie	Biomedical Engineering
Layla	Berry	Women Studies
Leopoldo	Picazo	Health Management
Lila	Yang	Commun-Integrated Marketing
Loy	Vo	Accounting
Lujain	Alzidlani	Nursing
Margarita	Huerta	Computer Science BS
Maribel	Sanchez-Equihua	Span for the Professions Cert
Mary	Greenwood	Social Work
Mayrelee	Kirgis	Accounting
Melinda	Engel	Exercise Science
Narra	Lam	Computer Engineering
Nhu	Nguyen	Mechanical Engineering
Nicole	Reynolds	Field Major Psychology
Noelle	Thompson	Psychology
Olivia	Ferdin	Biological Sciences BS
Raymond	O'Day	Exercise Science
Ron	Lam	Human Resource Management
Samantha	Rowan	Health Management
Samantha	Santander	Management
Shannel	Ramsey	Economics
Sofia	Salinas	Biomedical Engineering
Tachina	Taylor	Exercise Science
Tameka	Irving	Social Work
Thanh	Pham	Health Management
Thuy	Thai	Mechanical Engineering
Trevor	Owen	Biomedical Engineering
Truc	Nguyen	Mechanical Engineering
Valeria	Rodriguez	Dental Hygiene
Vanessa	Hall	ECU/Elementary Educ Apprentice
Ya-Aida	Sillah	Health Management
Yulissa	Hernandez	Human Resource Management
Zane	Storlie	Computer Science BS